

Prayers for our World and the Church

7th September 2025

Psalm 13:5-6

[5] But I have trusted in your steadfast love; my heart shall rejoice in your salvation.

[6] I will sing to the Lord, because he has dealt bountifully with me.

Let us pray...

Thanks to God

Father GOD, we thank You that You have dealt bountifully with us, as individual believers, and as a congregation called together to worship You in this place.

We thank You that we have been forgiven by Your grace and mercy alone, and have been set free from sin.

We thank You that we can rejoice in the Cross and the Resurrection, which secured our eternal salvation. We know that we could not do anything to save ourselves, and we must trust entirely in Your steadfast love towards us. We thank You for the New Life which Jesus imparted to us when we turned to You and confessed our sin.

We thank You for the Holy Spirit Who is with us daily, enabling us to make sense of the events in this world which swirl around us, beyond our control. We thank You that He shows us the Way of eternal Life, as He sanctifies us progressively in our daily walk.

The Wide World... and the Wider Church

We pray for this world where war continues in the Middle East and Ukraine, and we are surprised by strange events, but You remain in control, bringing about Your purposes, even from the bad things we see happening. We pray for Your people, in churches as well as in hidden communities suffering persecution, or working to bring relief to refugees, or in other parts of the world suffering from the results of these conflicts.

We pray for our nation, enjoying relative peace, and give You thanks that we can meet openly and freely. We also recognise that there are those who express hatred towards Jewish people and towards Your church. We pray for those enemies to turn away from hatred, and we pray that they would hear the Good News, and turn back to You.

Ashburton

We pray for our work at Ashburton, as we face our new situation, trusting in Your purposes for us here. We pray for the Session which meets next week, that You grant wisdom and strength as Douglas, Mook and I seek to follow Your leading. We thank You that in Your providence, the timing of these changes will enable Mook to pursue Your calling on his life in a new way, and that we continue to support him and Talia and the family as they trust You for their future.

We thank You for the support we receive from the wider denomination, from the Presbytery in particular, and we give thanks for Your Word, and for Alan as he preaches today. Help us to take it in, and apply what we hear to our everyday walk and work this week.

In Jesus Precious Name we pray, Amen.